even the outward feel and quality, let alone inward details, of game-theoretic situations without recourse to formulas. R. A. Fisher in his introduction to his great book on evolution wrote, "No efforts of mine could avail to make the book easy reading." In that book, under a rain of formulas and of sentences as profound as terse, the reader is soon battered into acquiescence. Having read *The Selfish Gene* I now feel that Fisher could have done better, although, admittedly, he would have had to write a different kind of book. It looks as though even the formative ideas of classic population genetics could have been made much more interesting in ordinary prose than they ever were. (Indeed, Haldane did manage somewhat better than Fisher in this, but was less profound.) But what is really remarkable is how much of the rather tedious mathematics that comes in the mainstream of population genetics following the lead of Wright, Fisher, and Haldane can be bypassed in the new, more social approach to the facts of life. I was rather surprised to find Dawkins sharing my assessment of Fisher as "the greatest biologist of the twentieth century" (a rare view, as I thought); but I was also surprised to note how little he had to reiterate Fisher's book.

Finally, in his last chapter, Dawkins comes to the fascinating subject of the evolution of culture. He floats the term "meme" (short for "mimeme") for the cultural equivalent of "gene." Hard as this term may be to delimit—it surely must be harder than gene, which is bad enough—I suspect that it will soon be in common use by biologists and, one hopes, by philosophers, linguists, and others as well and that it may become absorbed as far as the word "gene" has been into everyday speech.

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